

Chapter 25 — Niphal Weak-Form Identification Drill

BBH Chapter 25 · Niphal Weak Verbs

Part A (1–40): forms are grouped by weak class. Identify class, parse conjugation + PGN, and give the root. Part B (41–52): mixed classes — identify the class first, then parse. Answer key is on the last page.

Classes: III-א (silent final א) | III-ה (final ה / ה / תִּי / apocopated) | III-ch/ayin (patach furtive before ח/ע; patach in short forms) | I-guttural (ג, / י, / ה, prefix; no dagesh in R1) | I-ל (dagesh forte in R2; root ל invisible) | I-ו (prefix in perfect/ptc; ו, ו, / ו, / in impf/wayyiqtol/imv/inf) | Biconsonantal (ג, prefix in perfect/ptc; dagesh in R1 elsewhere) | Geminate (ג, prefix in perfect/ptc — same as Biconsonantal!; dagesh forte in R2/R3 elsewhere; R2=R3 is the class marker)

Part A — By Class

#	Hebrew	Conjugation	Ref	Contextual Gloss	Function
1	נִמְצָא	Perfect	Gen 44:12	"it was found"	
2	יִמְצָא	Imperfect	Gen 44:10	"let it be found"	
3	וַיִּמְצָא	Wayyiqtol	Gen 44:12	"and it was found"	
4	הִמְצָא	Inf. Abs.	Exo 22:3	"actually found" (emph.)	
5	הַנִּמְצָא	Participle ms	Gen 47:14	"that which was found"	
6	נִגְלָה	Perfect	Isa 40:5	"it was revealed"	
7	יִגְלָה	Imperfect	Isa 53:1	"it will be revealed"	
8	וַיִּגְלֵ	Wayyiqtol	Num 24:4	"whose eyes are unveiled"	
9	לְהַגְלוֹת	Inf. Construct	Isa 49:9	"to show themselves"	
10	וַיֵּרָא	Wayyiqtol	Gen 12:7	"and the LORD appeared"	
11	נֶאֱמַר	Perfect	Exo 5:13	"it was said"	
12	יֵאֱמַר	Imperfect	Num 21:14	"it is said"	
13	וַיֵּאֱמַר	Wayyiqtol	Gen 10:9	"and it was said of him"	
14	הָעֵמֶד	Inf. Construct	Exo 9:16	"for this purpose I let you stand"	
15	נֶאֱמָן	Participle ms	Deu 7:9	"faithful, trustworthy"	
16	נִגַּשׁ	Perfect	Gen 44:18	"he drew near"	
17	וַיִּגַּשׁ	Wayyiqtol	Gen 44:18	"and he drew near"	
18	נִצַּלְתֶּם	Perfect	Exo 12:27	"you were delivered"	
19	הִנָּצַל	Imperative	Prov 6:3	"deliver yourself!"	
20	וַיִּנָּצַל	Wayyiqtol	Gen 32:31	"and Jacob was delivered"	
21	נִוּלַד	Perfect	Gen 21:3	"he was born"	
22	וַיִּוּלַד	Wayyiqtol	Gen 4:18	"and he was born"	
23	יִוּלַד	Imperfect	Gen 17:17	"shall a child be born?"	
24	בְּהוּלַד	Inf. Construct	Gen 21:5	"when he was born"	
25	נוֹלֵד	Participle ms	1 Kgs 13:2	"one who will be born"	
26	נִשְׁמַע	Perfect	Est 1:20	"it was heard"	
27	יִשְׁמַע	Imperfect	Exo 28:35	"it shall be heard"	
28	וַיִּשְׁמַע	Wayyiqtol	Gen 45:2	"and it was heard"	
29	הִשְׁמַע	Inf. Construct	Deu 4:32	"to be heard"	
30	נִשְׁמָע	Participle ms	Ecc 12:13	"that which is heard"	
31	נִכּוֹן	Perfect	Gen 41:32	"it is established"	
32	יִכּוֹן	Imperfect	Psa 93:2	"it is established"	

Part B — Mixed

#	Hebrew	Conjugation	Ref	Contextual Gloss	Function
41	תִּרְאֶה	Imperfect/Jussive	Gen 1:9	"let it appear"	
42	הָיָה יָדוּעַ	Wayyiqtol	Est 2:22	"the matter became known"	
43	נִעַמַּד	Perfect	1 Sam 17:16	"he took his stand"	
44	הִתְאַסְּפוּ	Wayyiqtol	Gen 47:14	"all the silver was gathered"	
45	נֹדָע	Perfect	Gen 41:21	"it was not known"	
46	הִתְגַּשָּׁה	Wayyiqtol	Gen 44:18	"Judah drew near"	
47	הִרְאֵה	Imperative	1 Kgs 18:1	"show yourself!"	
48	נִשְׁלַח	Perfect	Est 3:13	"letters were sent"	
49	נִכּוֹן	Perfect/Participle	Exo 34:2	"be ready"	
50	הִסְבִּיחַ	Wayyiqtol	2 Sam 5:23	"and he circled behind them"	
51	נִמְצָא	Perfect	Exo 12:19	"whoever is found"	
52	יַעֲמִידוּ	Imperfect	Num 27:22	"they shall stand before"	

Reflection Questions

- Items 1 and 5 (III-א) are both pointed נִצַּח — perfect 3ms and participle ms are identical. What contextual or syntactic clues allow you to distinguish them in a real text?
- Compare items 8 (לִיגִי, III-ה) and 17 (לִישִׁיגִי, I-ו). Both show a short form after לִיגִי with a dagesh. How do you tell them apart?
- Items 10 (אֶרֶבִּי) and 13 (רַמֶּאֱבִי) both use the prefix אֶרֶבִּי instead of the expected אֶרֶבִּי. Is this the same phonological rule in both cases?
- Items 21 (דִּלִּי) and 25 (דִּלִּי) differ only in the vowel under R2. Which is the perfect and which is the participle, and how would each behave differently in a clause?
- Items 26 (עֲמִשׁ, III-ח/ע) and item 1 (נִצַּח, III-א) both begin with נִ. What distinguishes them visually, and why does the patach furtive appear before עֲמִשׁ but not נִצַּח?
- Items 31 and 33 both show רִכְבִּי (Biconsonantal). How does this perfect/participle ambiguity parallel the III-א problem in question 1, and what does it reveal about the general challenge of Niphal weak forms?
- Items 36 and 40 (Geminate) are both pointed בִּסְבִּי — perfect 3ms and participle ms are identical in the Geminate class, just like the Biconsonantal class (items 31/33). Given a form like בִּסְבִּי, how do you even know whether the root is Geminate (ס־ב־ס) or Biconsonantal (a hollow root)? What information outside the vocalization must you use?

Answer Key

#	Hebrew	Ref	Fn	Explanation
1	נִמְצָא	Gen 44:12	III-■	Perfect 3ms — silent final א
2	יִמְצָא	Gen 44:10	III-■	Imperfect 3ms — tsere + silent א
3	יִמְצֹא	Gen 44:12	III-■	Wayyiqtol 3ms — dagesh + final silent א
4	הַמִּצָּא	Exo 22:3	III-■	Inf. Absolute (= inf. construct form)
5	הַנִּמְצָא	Gen 47:14	III-■	Participle ms — article + נ + silent final א
6	נִגְלָה	Isa 40:5	III-■	Perfect 3ms — final ה
7	יִגְלָה	Isa 53:1	III-■	Imperfect 3ms — final ה (not tsere)
8	יִגְלֶה	Num 24:4	III-■	Wayyiqtol 3ms — apocopated (ה dropped)
9	לְהַגְלוֹת	Isa 49:9	III-■	Inf. Construct — ת suffix
10	יִרְאֶה	Gen 12:7	III-■	Wayyiqtol 3ms — apocopated + ר compensatory tsere
11	יִרְאֶה	Exo 5:13	I-guttural	Perfect 3ms — י prefix + composite shewa
12	יִרְאֶה	Num 21:14	I-guttural	Imperfect 3ms — י prefix; no dagesh in א
13	יִרְאֶה	Gen 10:9	I-guttural	Wayyiqtol 3ms — י (not יִרְאֶה)
14	הָעֵמֶד	Exo 9:16	I-guttural	Inf. Construct — ה prefix; no dagesh in ע
15	נֶאֱמַן	Deu 7:9	I-guttural	Participle ms — נ prefix + qamets under R2
16	נִגַּשׁ	Gen 44:18	I-■	Perfect 3ms — dagesh forte in ג (R2)
17	יִגַּשׁ	Gen 44:18	I-■	Wayyiqtol 3ms — dagesh in ג (R2)
18	נִצְלָתָם	Exo 12:27	I-■	Perfect 2mp — dagesh in צ (R2)
19	הִנְצֵל	Prov 6:3	I-■	Imperative 2ms — dagesh in נ (R2)
20	יִנְצֵל	Gen 32:31	I-■	Wayyiqtol 3ms — dagesh in נ (R2)
21	נִלְדָּה	Gen 21:3	I-■	Perfect 3ms — נ prefix + patach under R2
22	וַיִּלְד	Gen 4:18	I-■	Wayyiqtol 3ms — ו, י, ל cluster
23	יִלְדָּה	Gen 17:17	I-■	Imperfect 3ms — ו, י, ל cluster + tsere
24	בְּהִילֵד	Gen 21:5	I-■	Inf. Construct — ה, ו, ל prefix + ב
25	נִלְדָּה	1 Kgs 13:2	I-■	Participle ms — נ prefix + qamets (vs. patach in perfect)
26	נִשְׁמַע	Est 1:20	III-ch/ayin	Perfect 3ms — patach furtive before final ע
27	יִשְׁמַע	Exo 28:35	III-ch/ayin	Imperfect 3ms — patach (not tsere) before ע; dagesh in R1
28	יִשְׁמַע	Gen 45:2	III-ch/ayin	Wayyiqtol 3ms — patach before ע; no furtive
29	הַשְׁמַע	Deu 4:32	III-ch/ayin	Inf. Construct (= Imperative form) — patach before ע
30	נִשְׁמַע	Ecc 12:13	III-ch/ayin	Participle ms — qamets + patach furtive before ע
31	יָבוֹן	Gen 41:32	Biconsonantal	Perfect 3ms — י prefix (qamets) + medial ב
32	יִבוֹן	Psa 93:2	Biconsonantal	Imperfect 3ms — dagesh in R1 (Niphal assimilation) + contracted root
33	יָבוֹן	Psa 57:8	Biconsonantal	Participle ms — י prefix + vocalic structure = identical to perfect
34	יִבוֹן (expected)		Biconsonantal	Wayyiqtol 3ms — ו, י, ב + dagesh in R1 + contracted root
35	יָבוֹן (expected)		Biconsonantal	Imperative 2ms — ה, + dagesh in R1 + contracted root
36	נִסַּב	Josh 15:3	Geminate	Perfect 3ms — נ prefix (qamets), same as Biconsonantal; root ס-ב-ס has R2=R3
37	יִסַּב	1 Sam 7:16	Geminate	Wayyiqtol 3ms — dagesh forte in ב (R2=R3 doubled)
38	יִסַּב	Josh 19:34	Geminate	Imperfect 3ms — dagesh forte in ב; holem in contracted root
39	הִסַּב	2 Sam 18:30	Geminate	Imperative 2ms — ה, + dagesh forte in ב
40	נִסַּב	Psa 26:6	Geminate	Participle ms — נ prefix, identical to perfect 3ms; context determines
41	תִּרְאֶה	Gen 1:9	III-■	3fs — ר compensatory + final ה
42	וַיִּדַּע	Est 2:22	I-■	3ms — ו, י, ד; patach under R2 (י, ד, ע class)

43	נַעֲמֵד	1 Sam 17:16	I-guttural	3ms — נַ prefix + composite shewa under ך
44	וַיִּמְצְאוּ	Gen 47:14	III-■	3mp — dagesh + 3mp ending + silent ך
45	נוֹדַעַ	Gen 41:21	I-■	3ms — וֹנַ prefix + patach (perfect, not participle)
46	וַיִּגַּשׁ	Gen 44:18	I-■	3ms — dagesh in ג (R2); root נ invisible
47	הִרְאֵה	1 Kgs 18:1	III-■	2ms — הַ compensatory + final הַ (imperative)
48	נִשְׁלַח	Est 3:13	III-ch/ayin	3ms — patach furtive before final ח
49	נִכּוֹן	Exo 34:2	Biconsonantal	נַ prefix (qamets) is the biconsonantal Niphal marker
50	וַיִּסֹּב	2 Sam 5:23	Geminate	3ms — וַיִּ + dagesh forte in ב (R2=R3); root ס-ב-ב is Geminate, not hollow
51	נִמְצְאוּ	Exo 12:19	III-■	3cp — 3cp ending + final silent ך
52	וַיַּעֲמִדוּ	Num 27:22	I-guttural	3mp — וַיַּ prefix; no dagesh in ך; 3mp ending